JIYAN BAI

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EDUCATION

Ph.D.	Economics, University at Albany, State University of New York, NY	2018–Present
M.A.	Finance, University of La Verne, CA	2014–2016
B.A.	International Trade and Finance, Jincheng College, China	2009–2013

FIELD OF INTERESTS

Labor Economics, Applied Economics, Behavioral Economics, Macroeconomics, Search and Matching

WORKING PAPER

"Rank Matters: On-the-Job Search Model with Social Comparison Behavior" *(Job Market Paper)*

Objective: Study how workers' wage rank within a reference group affects job satisfaction, search behavior, and labor market outcomes.

- Built a longitudinal NLSY97 panel linking weekly employment histories with wages, demographics, job characteristics, and job satisfaction; constructed within-reference-group wage-rank measures.
- Applied OLS and panel random- and fixed-effects models, with complementary logit/probit specifications, to estimate the relationship between wage rank and job satisfaction.
- Developed and calibrated an on-the-job search model with rank-based utility to quantify implications for reservation wages, search efforts, unemployment, wage dispersion, and social welfare.
- Found that stronger rank concerns raise reservation wages and reduces equilibrium job mobility, increase unemployment, compress accepted-wage dispersion, and lower social welfare.

WORKS IN PROGRESS

"Comparison Behavior, Fairness, and On-the-Job Search Model"

"Comparison Behavior and Noisy Search"

RESEARCH & PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Data Analyst Intern, New York State Office of Mental Health, Albany, NY — Aug. 2025–Present

- Analyze Medicaid claims volume, recipient counts, total expenditure, utilization, and PMPM measures across FFS and encounter claims by service, plan, and provider to identify medical cost trend drivers.
- Conducted statistical and time-series analysis on Medicaid claims panel to identify trends, seasonality, and billing patterns across mental health services.
- Applied healthcare policy rules in SAS and incorporated 3M Clinical Risk Groups to identify potentially eligible members for targeted services.

Business Analyst Intern, New York State Department of Taxation and Finance, Albany, NY — 2020–2022

- Conducted literature review on IRS audit practice across income groups, with a particular emphasis on audits of Earned Income Tax Credit (EITC) recipients.
- Prepared and delivered audit-comparison reports (IRS vs. NYS) using SAS, SQL, and SPSS Modeler.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor, ECO 360: International Economic Relations, University at Albany — Spring 2025

Instructor, ECO 350: Money and Banking, University at Albany — Spring 2025

Instructor, ECO 111: Principles of Economics (Macro), University at Albany — Fall 2024

Instructor, ECO 350: Money and Banking, University at Albany — Spring 2023

Instructor, ECO 111: Principles of Economics (Macro), University at Albany — Winter 2022

Teaching Assistant, ECO 501: Macroeconomics, University at Albany — Fall 2018

CONFERENCES & POSTER PRESENTATIONS

Poster Presentation

"Rank Matters: On-the-Job Search Model with Social Comparison Behavior," UAlbany Showcase, University at Albany, SUNY — 2026

Conference Participation

Laboratory for Aggregate Economics and Finance Conference on Demographics and the Macroeconomy — 2025

Laboratory for Aggregate Economics and Finance Conference on Labor Markets and Macroeconomic Outcomes — 2022

AWARDS & SCHOLARSHIPS

Helen Horowitz Teaching Award, Department of Economics, University at Albany — 2025

Graduate Assistantship, University at Albany — 2018–2020

TECHNICAL SKILLS

SAS, Stata, R, Python, SQL, MATLAB, LaTeX, Tableau, Excel

REFERENCES

Available upon request.